



CST 309: GLOBAL CITIZENSHIP

A. Course Information:

Course Code	CST 309
Course Title	Global Citizenship
Course Instructor	Sharmistha Ghosh (SRG)
Course Time & Location	Sunday & Tuesday 12.30 pm - 1.50 pm, Room 9E 23C
Instructor Email	sharmistha.ghosh@bracu.ac.bd
Instructor Office Hours	Thursdays 1.00 pm - 2.30 pm and by appointment
Office Location	School of General Education, 5th floor, Section E, Room 5E03
Credit Hours	Three (3) credits
Category	GenEd (Stream 4)
Type	Elective
Prerequisites:	None
Co-requisites:	None

Course Description

(Lewis Carroll, *Alice in Wonderland*)

“jam yesterday and jam tomorrow, but never jam today.”

From its earliest conceptions, citizenship has been tied to the democratic principle of self-rule. And yet, contemporary forms of national citizenship are often associated with undemocratic outcomes of exclusion and intolerance. Alternative formulations of global citizenship that transcend territory- and community-specific claims propose more inclusive and active forms of rights and participation that would address global and transnational challenges today.

This course introduces the idea of citizenship from a historical and conceptual perspective, and explores its uses and disadvantages in the global present. The aim is to trace the main ideals and institutions of modern citizenship as a step towards imagining global citizenship as an emerging reality, sensibility, institution, and/or platform for common action. The course is divided into three parts. In the first part, we begin by tracing the meanings and practices of citizenship rooted in the political experiences of modern empires and nation- states. Following a critical analysis of the dominant form of “nation-state-citizenship” that emerged in the twentieth century, we explore other forms of citizenship. We begin with an overview of “universal” and “racial” conceptions of membership, belonging, and rights in the British Empire. Next, we examine some ideas and theories of what it might mean to “act like a global citizen.” In the final part, we turn to a series of global challenges posed by displacement and “statelessness,” and the role of citizenship (if any) in addressing these challenges. Focusing on the Rohingya refugee experiences, we explore the usefulness and challenges of developing the solidarities and institutions of “global citizenship.”

B. Rationale of the Course:

Students will learn how to recognize and evaluate different conceptions of citizenship, and articulate their own understanding of global citizenship. The course is also designed to equip students with advanced learning skills to enable them to address complex problems through critical analysis of global, national,

and

democratic issues, and to foster creativity of thought and expression through the appreciation of alternative practices in diverse cultural and professional settings.

C. Program Outcomes (POs):

SL.	PO Description
PO1	<i>Describe</i> a range of local and global issues/knowledge/ideas and their interconnections, beyond their major and minor;
PO2	<i>Demonstrate</i> proficiency in university level language comprehension, analytical writing skills and oral presentations;
PO3	<i>Apply</i> knowledge towards problem solving in and outside the classroom, especially through activities that contribute to the SDGs;
PO4	<i>Value</i> diversity and inclusion in race, religion, gender, sexuality, ethnicity, economic and class backgrounds
PO5	<i>Exhibit</i> sensitive and ethical leadership through course material taught, engaged pedagogical tools, class assignments, teamwork and exposure to real-life problems

D. Course Objectives:

As a part of the liberal arts curriculum, this course is closely aligned with two primary objectives. The **first objective** is to introduce students to a wide base of interdisciplinary knowledge in areas that lie outside the major fields of specialization. The **second objective** is to prepare students for academic success in the undergraduate program and beyond by enhancing learning skills in critical reading, analyses, writing, and public speaking. In addition to the program learning outcomes, this course will seek to meet the following course-specific objectives with respect to both the course content and learning methodologies:

E. Course Outcomes (COs):

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

SL.	CO Description
CO1	Introduce students to important concepts and theories of citizenship;
CO2	Introduce students to the contemporary political forms of nation-state citizenship;
CO3	Critical and comparative analysis of the limits of citizenship as a mode of political organization;
CO4	Examine case studies of contemporary global issues related to stateless and climate change;
CO5	Invite students to imagine modes of political belonging and participation beyond the nation-state;
CO6	Instill a sense of agency and activism in addressing difficult global problems.
CO7	Explore the meanings and responsibilities of participating in a global community

F. Mapping of Course Outcomes (COs) with Program Outcomes (POs)

	CO1	CO2	CO3	CO4	CO5	CO6	CO7
PO1	X	X		X	X	X	X
PO2	X	X	X				X
PO3			X		X	X	X
PO4					X	X	X
PO5					X	X	X

G. Schedule of Topics and Readings

Dates	Topics & Readings
9/6	Introduction to Course Topics and Aims • No required readings for this class.
14/6	First Impressions: “Citizenship in Times of Crisis” • No required readings for this class. Assignment: Details provided in google classrooms
PART ONE	BORDERS, BELONGING, CITIZENSHIP IN THE NATION-STATE
16/6	Citizenship and Nations • Anderson, B. <i>Imagined Community</i> (Verso, 1983), 1-7, 37-46. • Habermas, J. “Citizenship and National Identity” in <i>Between Facts and Norms</i> (MIT Press, 1996), 491-500.
21/6	Citizenship and States • Brubaker, R. “Citizenship as Social Closure” in <i>Citizenship and Nationhood in France and Germany</i> (Harvard University Press, 1992), 21-34. • Agnew, J. “The Territorial Trap: The Geographic Assumptions of International Relations Theory,” <i>Review International Political Economy</i>, 1: 1 (1994), 60-71.
23/6	Nation-States and Citizenship Crisis (Part 1) • Arendt, H. “The Decline of the Nation-State and the End of the Rights of Man,” in <i>The Origins of Totalitarianism</i> (Harcourt, 1968), 267-302.
28/6	Nation-States and Citizenship Crisis (Part 2) • Arendt, H. “The Decline of the Nation-State and the End of the Rights of Man,” in <i>The Origins of Totalitarianism</i> (Harcourt, 1968), 267-302.
30/6	Refugees and Inter-State System • Agamben, Giorgio. “The State of Exception as a Paradigm of Government”. <i>State of Exception</i>, Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 2004, pp. 1-31
5/7	• Quiz • Introduction to Citizen and Democracy

7/7	Citizenship and Democracy ● Balibar. E. <i>Citizenship</i> (Polity Press, 2015), 1-28.
12/7	Citizenship and Exclusion ● Balibar. E. <i>Citizenship</i> (Polity Press, 2015), 62-82. ● Cristina Beltran, <i>Cruelty as Citizenship: How Migrant Suffering Sustains White Democracy</i> (Minneapolis: University of Minnesota Press, 2020), 1-32.
14/7	Minorities and Citizenship in Bangladesh ● Siddiqi, D. “Left Behind by the Nation: ‘stranded Pakistanis’ in Bangladesh,” in <i>Sites</i>, 10:1 (2013), 150-183. ● Bal, E. & N. Siraj, “We are the True Citizens of the Country,” in <i>Asian Journal of Social Science</i> 45:6 (2017), 666-692. ● Chakraborty, P. Ethnic Conflict in the Chittagong Hill Tracts (CHT) of Bangladesh: Politics of Homogenization. <i>The Indian Journal of Political Science</i>, Vol. 75, No. 2 (April - June, 2014), pp. 297-304 (8 pages) ● Lein, H. (2000). Hazards and “forced” migration in Bangladesh. <i>Norsk Geografisk Tidsskrift - Norwegian Journal of Geography</i>, 54(3), 122–127. https://doi.org/10.1080/002919500423735 ● Sumi, M. J., Bulan, R., & Karim, M. E. (2025). The land rights of plain land indigenous Santal community in Bangladesh: Challenges and prospects. <i>International Journal of Innovation Studies</i>, 9(1) ● Sen, D. (2018). Introduction: Rethinking castelessness in mid-twentieth-century Bengal. In <i>The decline of the caste question: Jogendranath Mandal and the defeat of Dalit politics in Bengal</i>. Cambridge University Press. ● Siddiqi, Dina. (2020). Weaponizing Paperwork- Rohingya Belonging and Statelessness. 22. 1-16.
19/7 & 21/7	● Midterm Assignment Discussion/ Review Class ● Midterm Assignment Discussion/ Review Class MIDTERM SUBMISSION- 25th July, 2026
MIDTERM WEEK 25/07-02/08 (Viva Date TBA)	
4/8	In class workshop for community based work
PART TWO	BORDERS, BELONGING & CITIZENSHIP BEYOND NATION-STATE Membership, Belonging, and Rights in Empire

11/8	• Lake, M. & H. Reynolds, <i>Drawing the Global Color Line</i> (Cambridge University Press, 2008), 1-14 • Martha Nussbaum, "Patriotism and Cosmopolitanism" in <i>For Love of Country</i> (Boston: Beacon Press, 2002), 3-17. • <i>Handbook of Citizenship Studies</i>, (Sage, 2002), 317-332
16/8	Citizenship and Whiteness • Minutes of Proceedings of Imperial Conference, 1911, "Naturalization" (249-271), "Position of British Indians in Dominions" (394-400). From Citizens to Immigrants • Adams, C. <i>Across seven seas and thirteen rivers: Life stories of pioneer Sylhetti settlers in Britain</i> (THAP Books, 1987). Selections
18/8	Democracy and Globalization • Held, D. "The Changing Contours of Political Community: Rethinking Democracy in the Context of Globalisation," <i>Theoria</i> (December 1999), 30-46. • Linklater, A. "Cosmopolitan Citizenship," in in E. Isin & B. Turner (eds.),
23/8 & 25/8	Concept map/ Posters and Gallery Walk
30/8	Reconfiguring Citizenship from Below • Isin, E. "Citizenship in Flux: The Figure of the Activist Citizen," <i>Subjectivity</i> 29:1 (2009), 367-388. • Keck, M. & K. Sikkink, "Transnational Advocacy Networks in International and Regional Politics," <i>International Social Science Journal</i> 51:159 (1999): 89-101.
1/9 & 6/9	Finals workshops and discussion
8/9	Finals presentations

Learning Materials:

1. All course readings will be available via Google Classroom/Drive folder.
2. Instructions for the assignments will be handed out in the classroom.

H. Assessment and Evaluation:

Teaching and Learning Strategy. This is a reading- and writing-intensive course designed to facilitate self-learning through active student engagement in a variety of course-related reading, writing, critical analysis, and discussion activities. The course resources include course readings on each topic. In addition, the weekly pedagogic activities include brief lectures, student presentations, in- class writing assignments, weekly reading and reflections worksheets, and small-group discussions.

Assessment Strategy. The assessments of student performance are carried out throughout the

semester by a variety of feedback mechanisms. Student efforts in engaged learning are assessed by means of a variety of weekly completion- or effort-based assignments, including in-class writing. Attendance is mandatory in order to participate in classroom activities and discussions. In addition, the bulk of course grades is allocated to merit-based assignments in the form of take-home essays, exams and projects. Further details of course assignments and policies are attached at the end of this syllabus:

Marks distribution:

- | | |
|---|-------|
| 1. Participation and Group Activities | (15%) |
| 2. In/For-Class Writing | (15%) |
| 3. Reading Responses/Quiz/Concept Mapping | (20%) |
| 4. Midterm Essay | (20%) |
| 5. Final | (30%) |

Make-up Procedures: Make-up exams are only given under exceptional & documented circumstances. Please contact me if you are unable to complete your midterm or final exams.

I. Course Policies

- ☐ Students are expected to maintain all course decorum, and to treat each other with respect;
- ☐ Students are expected to complete all course readings and view the weekly taped lectures;
- ☐ Students are actively encouraged to attend all in-class sessions. If you are unable to attend the in-class, you will still be responsible for completing all the required writing submissions;
- ☐ Active participation in class discussions is expected and encouraged;
- ☐ The instructor reserves the right to make any necessary (announced) changes to the syllabus.
- ☐ The deadline for submission of all assignments will be provided by the course faculty. Students are expected to submit all assignments by their respective due dates, and all late work will result in partial or full loss of requisite points or marks – *Please plan ahead!*

J. Grading policy: Students' work will be graded according to the system specified by the BRAC University Undergraduate Study and Examinations Regulations, as specified below:

97-100	A+ (4.0) (Exceptional)
90 - 96	A (4.0) Excellent
85 - <90	A- (3.7)
80 - <85	B+ (3.3)
75 - <80	B (3.0) Good
70 - <75	B- (2.7)
65 - <70	C+ (2.3)
60 - <65	C (2.0) Fair
57 - <60	C- (1.7)
55 - <57	D+ (1.3)
52 - <55	D (1.0) Poor
50 - <52	D- (0.7)
<50	F (0.0) Failure

Plagiarism:

All students are expected to abide by the BRAC University Code of Academic Integrity. All assignments submitted by students must be their own work. Copying from another student or from published, unpublished, or electronic sources without appropriate citations or quotations is considered plagiarism. Any evidence of plagiarism will lead to an automatic "F" (fail) for all concerned students. In other words, if there is any evidence of plagiarism, ALL students involved will automatically receive a zero grade. According to university policy, all cases of plagiarism are reported to the Office of Academic Standards. The penalty for violation of this code can lead to a failing grade in the course as well as further disciplinary action by the university.

